SSC CGL, CPO (SI) & CHSL Tricky PYQs

Topic: Post-Gupta Period & Imperial Chola Dynasty | High-Yield Revision Set

QUESTION 1 • CHOLA TAXATION SYSTEM

In the context of the Chola Empire, which of the following taxes was collected not in cash, but in the form of forced labour?

(A) Kadamai
(B) Vetti
(C) Irai
(D) Kudimai

Correct Answer: (B) Vetti | **Exam: SSC CGL / CHSL (TCS Pattern)**

Explanation: Chola inscriptions mention over 400 different tax terms. *Kadamai* (also called *Irai*) was the standard land revenue paid in cash or produce, whereas **Vetti** was the most frequently mentioned tax taken specifically as **forced labour** (*vishti*) for public works like building temples and maintaining irrigation tanks.

QUESTION 2 • CHOLA LAND CLASSIFICATIONS

According to Chola inscriptions, what was the specific term used for land donated for the maintenance of a school?

(A) Vellanvagai
(B) Pallichchhandam
(C) Shalabhoga
(D) Devadana

Correct Answer: (C) Shalabhoga | **Exam: SSC CGL Tier-1**

Explanation: Chola inscriptions classify five distinct types of land grants: **Shalabhoga** (land for the maintenance of a school), *Vellanvagai* (land of non-Brahmana peasant proprietors), *Brahmadeya* (land gifted to Brahmanas), *Devadana / Tirunamattukkani* (land gifted to temples), and *Pallichchhandam* (land donated to Jaina institutions).

QUESTION 3 • POST-GUPTA ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICIALS

In the administration of Harshavardhana, the high-ranking official designated as *Mahasandhivigrahaka* was responsible for which portfolio?

(A) Chief Justice and Criminal Law

(B) Minister for War and Peace (Foreign Affairs)

(C) Chief Commander of the Cavalry

(D) Royal Treasurer and Revenue Collector

Correct Answer: (B) Minister for War and Peace (Foreign Affairs) | **Exam: SSC CGL / CPO (SI)**

Explanation: Under Emperor Harshavardhana, an official named **Avanti** held the title of **Mahasandhivigrahaka**, serving as the supreme minister for diplomacy, treaties, war, and peace. For comparison, *Singhanada* was the Commander-in-Chief of the army and *Kuntala* was the chief commander of the cavalry.

QUESTION 4 • CHOLA TEMPLE PLUNDER & TROPHIES

In the early eleventh century, the Chola king Rajendra I built a Shiva temple in his new capital and filled it with a Sun-pedestal seized from which dynasty?

(A) Palas

(B) Chalukyas

(C) Rashtrakutas

(D) Kalingas

Correct Answer: (B) Chalukyas | **Exam: SSC CGL Tier-1**

Explanation: While Rajendra I defeated the Palas and earned the title *Gangaikondachola*, NCERT-based SSC questions test the specific war trophies placed inside his temple at Gangaikondacholapuram: he seized a **Sun-pedestal from the Chalukyas**, a Ganesha statue and several statues of Durga, a Bhairava and Bhairavi image from the Kalingas of Orissa, and a Kali statue from the Palas of Bengal.

QUESTION 5 • POST-GUPTA RULERS & CONTEMPORARIES

Who among the following rulers of the Malwa region formed an alliance with Shashanka of Gauda and killed Harshavardhana's brother-in-law, Grahavarman?

(A) Devagupta

(B) Yashodharman

(C) Prabhakaravardhana

(D) Bhaskaravarman

Correct Answer: (A) Devagupta | **Exam: SSC CPO (SI) / CGL**

Explanation: Devagupta, the Later Gupta ruler of Malwa, formed a strategic alliance with Shashanka (ruler of Gauda in Bengal) to attack Kannauj and kill the Maukhari king **Grahavarman** (husband of Harsha's sister, Rajyashri). This event triggered the chain of wars that brought Harshavardhana to the throne at age 16.